

Computer Networks

Complete MCQ-Oriented Notes

IBPS SO (IT Officer) Examination - Complete Preparation Series

100% Syllabus Coverage - MCQ-Oriented - Zero Filler

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Network Fundamentals

Definition, Goals and Applications

- A **computer network** is a collection of **autonomous** computing devices interconnected by a single technology so they can **exchange data** and **share resources**.
- "Autonomous" means **no master-slave** relationship; if one machine can forcibly start/stop another it is not a network but a **distributed system** variant.
- Primary goals: **resource sharing**, **high reliability** (replication/alternate routes), **scalability**, **cost saving**, **communication medium**, and **load distribution**.
- A **distributed system** is a **software** (application-layer) layer built on top of a network that hides the network from the user; a **network** is the **hardware/protocol** substrate. Distinction is the **level of abstraction**.
- Applications: **business/resource sharing**, **home (access to remote info, e-commerce, IPTV)**, **mobile (m-commerce, sensor nets)**, and **social**.

Memory Trick

- Goals = "**RRSC**": **Reliability**, **Resource sharing**, **Scalability**, **Cost**.

CBT Trap

- **Network** vs **distributed system**: difference is **abstraction/software**, not hardware. The WWW runs on the Internet (**distributed system on a network**).

Network Types: LAN, MAN, WAN, PAN

- **PAN (Personal Area Network)**: range about **1-10 m**; example **Bluetooth**, USB; smallest scope.
- **LAN (Local Area Network)**: a **building/campus**, range up to **~1 km**; privately owned; **high speed (10 Mbps-10 Gbps)**, **low delay**, **low error**; tech **Ethernet/Wi-Fi**.
- **MAN (Metropolitan Area Network)**: spans a **city**, up to **~10-100 km**; example **cable TV**, **DOCSIS**, **WiMAX**.
- **WAN (Wide Area Network)**: **country/continent** scale; uses **public carriers**; lower speed, higher delay; the **Internet** is a WAN of WANs.
- Increasing order of geographic span: **PAN < LAN < MAN < WAN**.

Type	Span	Ownership	Example
PAN	1-10 m	Personal	Bluetooth
LAN	up to 1 km	Private	Ethernet
MAN	10-100 km	Private/Public	Cable/WiMAX
WAN	Country+	Public	Internet

CBT Trap

- **LAN** typically uses **broadcast** channels; **WAN** uses **point-to-point (switched)** links. **Internetwork** = networks joined by **routers/gateways**.

Topologies

- **Topology** = the physical/logical **arrangement** of nodes and links.
- **Bus**: single backbone cable; needs **terminators**; cheap but a **single break** kills the segment; uses **CSMA/CD**; n nodes need **1** cable and **1** I/O port each.
- **Star**: all nodes connect to a **central hub/switch**; needs **n** cables and **n** ports on hub; failure of a **link** affects only one node, but **hub failure** kills all; most common in modern LANs.

- **Ring**: each node connects to **2** neighbors forming a loop; uses **token passing**; **unidirectional** (or dual ring for fault tolerance); a single break can break the ring.
- **Mesh**: dedicated point-to-point link between every pair; needs $n(n-1)/2$ duplex links and **(n-1)** ports per node; **most robust**, most expensive.
- **Tree**: hierarchical extension of star (star of stars); used in **cable TV**.
- **Hybrid**: combination, e.g., **star-bus**.

Topology	Cables	Ports/node	Reliability
Mesh	$n(n-1)/2$	n-1	Highest
Star	n	1	Hub is SPOF
Bus	1	1	Low (backbone SPOF)
Ring	n	2	Break-sensitive

Memory Trick

- Mesh links = $nC2 = n(n-1)/2$. For **n=5**: **10** links.

CBT Trap

- Number of **cables** in mesh = $n(n-1)/2$; number of **ports** per device = **n-1**. Examiners swap these.

Transmission Modes

- **Simplex**: **one direction** only (e.g., keyboard to CPU, monitor); full bandwidth one way.
- **Half-duplex**: both directions but **one at a time** (e.g., **walkie-talkie**, CSMA/CD Ethernet hub).
- **Full-duplex**: both directions **simultaneously** (e.g., **telephone**, switched Ethernet); needs two channels or shared with separation.

CBT Trap

- **Half-duplex** shares one channel by turns; **full-duplex** needs **two** links or **frequency separation**. Capacity of full-duplex link is shared in both directions.

Connection-Oriented vs Connectionless

- **Connection-oriented**: **setup -> transfer -> teardown**; ordered, reliable; analogy **telephone**; example **TCP**, **virtual circuit**.
- **Connectionless**: each packet (**datagram**) routed **independently**; no setup; analogy **postal**; example **UDP**, **IP**.

Feature	Connection-oriented	Connectionless
Setup	Yes	No
Ordering	Guaranteed	Not guaranteed
Reliability	High	Best effort
Example	TCP/VC	UDP/IP

Performance Metrics

- **Bandwidth (bit rate)**: number of **bits per second** a link can carry; in Hz it is the frequency range. Digital bandwidth measured in **bps**.
- **Transmission delay (Tt)** = L / B = packet size (bits) / bandwidth (bps); time to **push all bits** onto the wire.
- **Propagation delay (Tp)** = $\text{distance} / \text{propagation speed} = d / v$; v approx **2×10^8 m/s** in copper/fiber (**3×10^8** in vacuum).
- **Queuing delay**: time a packet waits in **router buffers**; variable, load-dependent.

- **Processing delay**: time to **examine header** and decide forwarding.
- **End-to-end delay** = $n(T_t + T_p + T_q + T_{proc})$ for n hops (store-and-forward).
- **Throughput**: **actual** rate of successful delivery; always $\leq$ **bandwidth**.
- **Bandwidth-Delay Product (BDP)** = **Bandwidth x RTT** (or $\times T_p$) = max **bits in flight**; sets **optimal window size**.
- **RTT (Round-Trip Time)** = $2 \times T_p$ (+ processing) = time for a bit to go and the ACK to return.

Delay	Formula	Depends on
Transmission	L/B	Packet size, bandwidth
Propagation	d/v	Distance, medium
Queuing	variable	Congestion
Processing	variable	Router speed

Memory Trick

- **T_t** depends on **size**; **T_p** depends on **distance**. BDP = "**pipe volume**" = bandwidth $\times$ delay.

CBT Trap

- **Transmission delay** uses **bandwidth** (bps); **propagation delay** uses **speed** (m/s). Doubling bandwidth halves **T_t**, not **T_p**. For long-fat networks **T_p dominates**.

Layered Architecture

Need for Layering; Service vs Protocol vs Interface

- Layering provides **modularity**, **abstraction**, easier **design/maintenance**, and **interoperability**.
- A **service** = set of operations a layer offers to the layer **above** it (the "what").
- A **protocol** = set of **rules/format** governing communication between **peer** entities on different machines (the "how").
- An **interface** = tells the upper layer how to **access** the service (primitives between adjacent layers on the **same** machine).
- **Peer-to-peer** communication is **virtual**; actual data flows **down** the sender stack and **up** the receiver stack.

CBT Trap

- **Service** = vertical (between layers); **protocol** = horizontal (between peers). A layer can change its protocol without changing the **service**.

OSI Model (7 Layers)

- **OSI = Open Systems Interconnection**, by **ISO (1984)**; **7** layers; a **reference** model (rarely implemented as-is).
- Bottom to top: **Physical, Data Link, Network, Transport, Session, Presentation, Application**.
- **Layer 1 Physical**: transmits **raw bits**; deals with **voltage, pins, data rate, media, topology**; PDU = **bit**.
- **Layer 2 Data Link**: **node-to-node** delivery; **framing, MAC, flow & error control**; PDU = **frame**; addresses = **MAC**.
- **Layer 3 Network**: **host-to-host** across networks; **logical addressing (IP), routing**; PDU = **packet/datagram**.
- **Layer 4 Transport**: **process-to-process**; **segmentation, flow/error control, multiplexing**; PDU = **segment (TCP)/datagram (UDP)**.
- **Layer 5 Session**: **dialog control, synchronization, checkpoints**.
- **Layer 6 Presentation**: **translation, encryption, compression** (syntax/semantics).
- **Layer 7 Application**: **user services** (HTTP, FTP, SMTP, DNS).

Memory Trick

- Bottom-up: "**Please Do Not Throw Sausage Pizza Away**" = Physical, Data link, Network, Transport, Session, Presentation, Application.
- Top-down: "**All People Seem To Need Data Processing**".

CBT Trap

- **Encryption/compression** = **Presentation**; **dialog/sync** = **Session**; **routing** = **Network**; **flow control** appears at both **Data Link** (node) and **Transport** (end-to-end).

TCP/IP Model

- **TCP/IP = 4** layers (**DoD** model): **Application, Transport, Internet, Network Access (Link)**; or **5** layers if Physical separated.
- **Application** = OSI **5+6+7**; **Transport** = OSI **4** (**TCP/UDP**); **Internet** = OSI **3** (**IP**); **Link** = OSI **1+2**.
- The **Internet** layer's main protocol is **IP** (**connectionless**); the model was **descriptive** (built from protocols), unlike OSI which was **prescriptive**.

OSI vs TCP/IP

Aspect	OSI	TCP/IP
Layers	7	4 (or 5)
Origin	ISO , prescriptive	DoD , descriptive
Transport	Both reliable	TCP reliable, UDP unreliable
Use	Reference	Practical/Internet
Coupling	Strict layers	Loosely coupled

CBT Trap

- OSI has **7**, TCP/IP has **4**. OSI defines **services/interfaces/protocols** distinctly; TCP/IP does not. **Session** and **Presentation** have **no separate** layer in TCP/IP.

Encapsulation, Decapsulation and PDUs

- Encapsulation**: each layer adds its **header** (and DLL adds a **trailer**) as data goes **down** the sender stack.
- Decapsulation**: each layer **strips** its header going **up** the receiver stack.
- PDU names: Application = **data/message**, Transport = **segment/datagram**, Network = **packet/datagram**, Data Link = **frame**, Physical = **bits**.

Memory Trick

- PDU order down the stack: "**Data -> Segment -> Packet -> Frame -> Bits**".

CBT Trap

- Only **Data Link** adds a **trailer** (FCS); others add header only. **Segment** (TCP) vs **Datagram** (UDP/IP) naming is frequently tested.

Physical Layer Basics

Analog vs Digital Signals

- **Analog signal**: **continuous** values, infinitely many levels (e.g., voice).
- **Digital signal**: **discrete** levels (e.g., **0/1**); subject to **attenuation**, **noise**, **distortion**.
- **Bit interval** = time for one bit; **bit rate** = $1 / \text{bit interval}$.

Transmission Media

- **Guided (wired)**: **twisted pair**, **coaxial**, **fiber optic**.
- **Unguided (wireless)**: **radio**, **microwave**, **infrared**.
- **Twisted pair**: two insulated copper wires twisted to reduce **crosstalk**; **UTP** (Cat5e/Cat6) and **STP**; cheap; used in **LAN/telephone**; max ~**100 m** for Ethernet.
- **Coaxial**: central conductor + shield; higher bandwidth than twisted pair; used in **cable TV**.
- **Fiber optic**: carries light; **single-mode** (long haul, laser) and **multi-mode** (short, LED); immune to **EMI**, huge bandwidth, low attenuation, hard to tap (**secure**); most expensive.
- **Wireless**: no medium; **omnidirectional** (radio) vs **unidirectional** (microwave); affected by **interference**.

Medium	Bandwidth	EMI immunity	Cost
Twisted pair	Low-Med	Low	Low
Coax	Medium	Medium	Medium
Fiber	Highest	Highest	High

CBT Trap

- **Single-mode fiber** = **laser**, long distance; **multi-mode** = **LED**, short distance. Fiber is immune to **EMI** and hardest to **tap**.

Nyquist and Shannon Capacity

- **Nyquist (noiseless)**: $C = 2 \times B \times \log_2(L)$ bps, where B = bandwidth (Hz), L = number of signal levels.
- **Shannon (noisy)**: $C = B \times \log_2(1 + S/N)$ bps; S/N is the **signal-to-noise** ratio (linear).
- **SNR(dB)** = $10 \times \log_{10}(S/N)$; convert before using Shannon.
- When both apply, take the **lower** (Shannon caps the realistic max; Nyquist tells how many levels are usable).

Memory Trick

- Nyquist = "**2B log₂ L**" (levels); Shannon = "**B log₂(1+SNR)**" (noise). Nyquist has **no noise**; Shannon has **no levels**.

CBT Trap

- For SNR given in **dB**, first compute $S/N = 10^{(dB/10)}$. With SNR very high, Shannon $\rightarrow 0.332 \times B \times \text{SNR(dB)}$ approx. Examiners mix up which formula uses **levels (L)**.

Bit Rate vs Baud Rate

- **Bit rate** = bits/second; **baud rate** = **signal units (symbols)/second**.
- **Bit rate** = **baud rate** $\times \log_2(L)$ = baud $\times$ bits-per-symbol.
- **Baud rate** $\leq$ **bit rate** always; they are equal only when **1 bit per symbol (L=2)**.

CBT Trap

- **Baud** $\leq$ bit rate. Bandwidth requirement is governed by **baud rate**, not bit rate.

Encoding Schemes

- **NRZ (Non-Return to Zero)**: voltage stays constant during bit; **NRZ-L** (level) and **NRZ-I** (invert on 1); problem: **no self-clocking**, baseline wander on long runs.
- **Manchester**: each bit has a **mid-bit transition**; **self-clocking**; used in **Ethernet 10 Mbps**; needs **2x bandwidth** (baud = 2 x bit rate).
- **Differential Manchester**: transition at **start** represents bit; always mid-bit transition for clock.
- **RZ (Return to Zero)**: signal returns to zero mid-bit; three levels.

CBT Trap

- **Manchester** is **self-clocking** but uses **double** the bandwidth. **NRZ** is bandwidth-efficient but loses sync on long **0/1** runs.

Multiplexing

- **Multiplexing**: combining multiple signals over one shared **medium**.
- **FDM (Frequency Division)**: **analog**; divides **bandwidth** into frequency bands; needs **guard bands**; used in radio/TV.
- **TDM (Time Division)**: **digital**; divides **time** into slots; **Synchronous TDM** (fixed slots, may waste) vs **Statistical/Asynchronous TDM** (dynamic, efficient).
- **WDM (Wavelength Division)**: FDM for **fiber** (light wavelengths); uses prism to combine/split.

Technique	Domain	Signal	Use
FDM	Frequency	Analog	Radio/TV
TDM	Time	Digital	T1/E1
WDM	Wavelength	Optical	Fiber

CBT Trap

- **FDM/WDM** share **frequency/wavelength**; **TDM** shares **time**. **Statistical TDM** allocates slots **on demand**, no wasted slots.

Switching

Circuit Switching

- **Circuit switching**: a **dedicated** physical path is reserved end-to-end for the whole session; phases = **setup** -> **data transfer** -> **teardown**.
- Resources are **reserved** (**guaranteed bandwidth**) even if idle (**wasteful**); example **PSTN telephone**.
- No **addressing** per packet during transfer; **constant delay**; no congestion after setup.

Packet Switching

- **Packet switching**: data split into **packets**; each carries **header/address**; statistical sharing of links.
- **Datagram** approach: each packet routed **independently**; may arrive **out of order**; **connectionless**; example **IP**.
- **Virtual circuit** approach: **setup** establishes a path; packets carry a **VC number/label**; ordered delivery; **PVC** (permanent) and **SVC** (switched/on-demand); example **Frame Relay, ATM, MPLS**.

Message Switching

- **Message switching**: entire **message** stored and forwarded hop by hop (**store-and-forward**); no size limit; high **delay**; obsolete (telegraph).

Comparison

Feature	Circuit	Datagram packet	Virtual circuit
Setup	Yes	No	Yes
Path	Dedicated	Per-packet	Fixed per VC
Order	Preserved	May reorder	Preserved
Address	At setup	Full in every packet	VC id
Efficiency	Low	High	High

Memory Trick

- Circuit = "**phone call**"; Datagram = "**postcards**"; VC = "**reserved train track**".

CBT Trap

- **Virtual circuit** still does **store-and-forward** but uses **small VC labels** instead of full addresses. **Datagram** puts **full destination address** in every packet. Circuit switching reserves bandwidth even when **idle**.

Data Link Layer Services

Core Services

- The **Data Link Layer (DLL)** provides **node-to-node (hop-to-hop)** delivery over a single link.
- Functions: **framing**, **physical (MAC) addressing**, **flow control**, **error control**, **access control (MAC)**.
- **Flow control** matches sender speed to receiver capacity; **error control** handles damaged/lost frames via **ARQ**.

LLC vs MAC Sublayer

- **IEEE 802** splits DLL into **LLC (Logical Link Control, 802.2)** on top and **MAC (Media Access Control)** below.
- **LLC**: provides **flow/error control** and interface to network layer; **MAC**: controls **who accesses the medium** and does **framing/addressing**.

CBT Trap

- **LLC** is the **upper** sublayer (interface to L3); **MAC** is the **lower** sublayer (access to medium). MAC addresses live in the **MAC** sublayer.

Framing

Framing Methods

- **Framing**: dividing the bit stream into distinguishable **frames**.
- **Fixed-size framing**: no delimiters needed (e.g., **ATM cells = 53 bytes**).
- **Variable-size framing**: needs to mark frame **boundaries**.
- **Character/byte count**: first field gives frame **length**; fragile - a corrupted count **desynchronizes** everything.
- **Byte/character stuffing**: a **FLAG** byte marks boundaries; an **ESC** byte is stuffed before any data byte matching FLAG/ESC; byte-oriented (PPP).
- **Bit stuffing**: flag = **01111110** (0x7E); sender inserts a **0** after **five consecutive 1s** in data; receiver removes it; bit-oriented (**HDLC**).

Memory Trick

- Bit stuffing rule: after **five 1s**, stuff a **0**. Flag **01111110** = "**six 1s**".

CBT Trap

- Bit stuffing inserts **0** after **5** ones (not 6). Byte count method is the **least** robust. **Byte stuffing** is byte-oriented; **bit stuffing** is bit-oriented.

Error Detection and Correction

Error Types

- **Single-bit error**: only **one** bit flipped; rare in serial transmission.
- **Burst error**: **two or more** bits flipped; length = from first to last corrupted bit; common; favored by high data rate.

Hamming Distance

- **Hamming distance $d(x,y)$** = number of bit positions in which two codewords **differ** = **XOR then count 1s**.
- **Minimum Hamming distance $d_{\min}$** of a code determines power:
- To **detect** up to **s** errors: **$d_{\min} \geq s + 1$** .
- To **correct** up to **t** errors: **$d_{\min} \geq 2t + 1$** .

Memory Trick

- Detect s -> need **$s+1$** ; correct t -> need **$2t+1$** .

CBT Trap

- A code with **$d_{\min} = 3$** can **detect 2** and **correct 1**. Examiners ask "detect AND correct" -> **$d_{\min} \geq s + t + 1$** with $s \geq t$.

Parity Check

- **Simple parity**: add **1** parity bit so total 1s are **even (even parity)** or **odd**; detects **odd** number of bit errors only (**cannot** detect even errors); **$d_{\min} = 2$** .
- **Two-dimensional parity**: arrange bits in a table, parity per **row and column**; detects more burst errors and can **correct single-bit** errors.

CBT Trap

- Simple parity **cannot** detect **2-bit (even)** errors and **cannot correct** anything. 2D parity can correct a **single** bit (intersection of failing row and column).

Checksum (Internet Checksum)

- Used at **transport/network** layers; sender sums data in **16-bit** words using **1's complement** arithmetic, takes **1's complement** of the sum as checksum.
- Receiver sums all words **including** checksum; result of **all 1s** (zero in 1's complement) means **no error**.
- Wraps around **end-around carry**; weaker than CRC; cannot detect some **reordering/multiple** errors.

CBT Trap

- Internet checksum uses **1's complement** sum, not 2's complement. A **carry-out** is added back (**wrap-around**). It cannot catch errors that **cancel out**.

Cyclic Redundancy Check (CRC)

- **CRC** uses **modulo-2 (XOR)** polynomial division; based on a **generator polynomial $G(x)$** of degree **r**.
- Procedure: append **r** zeros to data, divide by G (XOR), the **remainder** (r bits) is the **CRC/FCS**; transmit **data + CRC**.
- Receiver divides received frame by G; remainder **0** = no detected error.
- Degree of generator **r** -> CRC has **r** bits; codeword length = data + r.

CRC Detection Capability

- Detects **all single-bit** errors if G has **≥ 2 terms**.
- Detects all **burst errors** of length **$\leq r$** .
- Detects **odd** number of bit errors if G contains the factor **$(x + 1)$** .
- Burst of length **$r+1$** detected with prob **$1 - (1/2)^{(r-1)}$** ; longer bursts **$1 - (1/2)^r$** .

Memory Trick

- "Append r zeros, XOR divide, send remainder". CRC-32 (Ethernet) has $r = 32$.

CBT Trap

- CRC uses XOR (mod-2), no carries. Number of CRC bits = degree r of G , NOT number of terms. A burst $\leq r$ is always caught.

Hamming Code (Single-bit Correction)

- Hamming code is a SEC (single error correcting) block code; redundant parity bits placed at positions that are powers of 2: 1, 2, 4, 8, 16,
- Number of redundant bits r for m data bits satisfies $2^r \geq m + r + 1$.
- Parity bit at position 2^i checks all positions whose binary index has bit i set.
- Receiver recomputes parities $\rightarrow$ the binary syndrome points directly to the erroneous bit position (0 = no error).

Memory Trick

- Parity positions = powers of 2. Need r so that $2^r \geq m + r + 1$. For $m=7$ data bits $\rightarrow r=4 \rightarrow$ code (11,7).

CBT Trap

- For $m=7$: $2^4=16 \geq 7+4+1=12$ so $r=4$. Hamming corrects 1 bit, detects 2 (with extra overall parity = SECDED). Parity bits go at powers of 2, not the end.

Flow and Error Control Protocols

Stop-and-Wait

- **Stop-and-Wait**: sender sends **one** frame, waits for **ACK** before next; simplest flow control.
- **Efficiency (utilization)** = $1 / (1 + 2a)$ where $a = T_p / T_t$.
- **Throughput = Efficiency x Bandwidth**; sender window = receiver window = **1**.

Stop-and-Wait ARQ

- Adds **sequence numbers** (0/1, 1 bit), **timeouts**, and **retransmission** for lost/damaged frames; ACKs are numbered.
- Handles **lost frame**, **lost ACK** (retransmit on timeout), and **delayed ACK** (sequence numbers prevent duplicates).

Memory Trick

- $a = T_p / T_t$. Efficiency = $1 / (1 + 2a)$. Sequence numbers need only **1** bit.

CBT Trap

- Stop-and-Wait window = **1**; efficiency $1 / (1 + 2a)$. For large a (long links) efficiency is **poor** -> use sliding window.

Sliding Window: Go-Back-N ARQ

- **Go-Back-N (GBN)**: sender window $N = 2^m - 1$ (m = sequence-number bits); receiver window = **1**.
- Receiver accepts **in-order** only, sends **cumulative ACK**; on a lost frame the sender **retransmits the frame and all subsequent (go back N)**.
- **Efficiency** = $N / (1 + 2a)$, capped at **1** when $N \geq 1 + 2a$.

Sliding Window: Selective Repeat ARQ

- **Selective Repeat (SR)**: only the **specific** lost/damaged frame is retransmitted; receiver **buffers** out-of-order frames; uses **NAK**/selective ACK.
- Window constraint: **sender window = receiver window** $\leq 2^{(m-1)}$ (half the sequence space).
- **Efficiency** = $N / (1 + 2a)$ with the larger usable N .

Window Size vs Sequence-Number Bits

- With m sequence bits, sequence space = 2^m .
- **GBN**: max sender window = $2^m - 1$.
- **SR**: max window = $2^{(m-1)}$ (sender = receiver).

Feature	Go-Back-N	Selective Repeat
Sender window	$2^m - 1$	$2^{(m-1)}$
Receiver window	1	$2^{(m-1)}$
Retransmit	All after lost	Only lost
Receiver buffer	No	Yes
ACK type	Cumulative	Selective

Piggybacking

- **Piggybacking**: attach the **ACK** of incoming data onto an **outgoing data** frame to improve efficiency in **bidirectional** communication; adds slight **delay** waiting for data to send.

Efficiency / Throughput Computations

- $a = T_p / T_t$; $T_t = L/B$; $T_p = d/v$.
- **Utilization (sliding window)** = $N / (1 + 2a)$ (when < 1).
- **Throughput** = $U \times B$.

Optimal Window Size and BDP

- **Optimal $N = 1 + 2a$** so the pipe stays **full**; this equals **$1 + BDP/L$** .
- **$BDP = B \times RTT = B \times 2T_p$** = max bits in flight.

Memory Trick

- " **$1 + 2a$** " is the magic number: efficiency **$N/(1+2a)$** , optimal window = **$1+2a$** .

CBT Trap

- **GBN** max window = **$2^m - 1$** ; **$SR = 2^{(m-1)}$** . If SR window $> 2^{(m-1)}$, sequence numbers **ambiguous**. For $m=3$: GBN=7, SR=4.

Medium Access Control (MAC)

Static vs Dynamic Allocation

- **Static**: fixed division (**FDM/TDM**); wasteful when traffic is **bursty**.
- **Dynamic**: allocate on demand; **random access**, **controlled access**, **channelization**.

Random Access: ALOHA

- **Pure ALOHA**: transmit **whenever** ready; vulnerable period = **$2 \times$ frame time**; max efficiency = **18.4% ($1/2e$)** at **$G = 0.5$** .
- **Slotted ALOHA**: transmit only at slot **start**; vulnerable period = **$1 \times$ frame time**; max efficiency = **36.8% ($1/e$)** at **$G = 1$** .
- Throughput **$S = G \times e^{(-2G)}$** (pure), **$S = G \times e^{(-G)}$** (slotted), where G = offered load.

Random Access: CSMA

- **CSMA = Carrier Sense Multiple Access**: "**listen before talk**".
- **1-persistent**: if idle, send **immediately** (prob 1); high collision.
- **Non-persistent**: if busy, wait a **random** time then sense again; fewer collisions, more delay.
- **p-persistent** (slotted): if idle, send with prob **p** , defer with **$1-p$** ; balances both.

CSMA/CD

- **CSMA/CD** = collision **detection**; used in **wired Ethernet (802.3)**; "**listen while talking**", abort on collision, send **jam** signal, **binary exponential backoff**.
- **Minimum frame size** needed so a sender is still transmitting when collision returns: **$T_t \geq 2 \times T_p$** , i.e., **$L \geq 2 \times B \times T_p$** .
- After k collisions, backoff chosen from **0 to $2^k - 1$** (capped at **$k=10$** , max **16** attempts).

CSMA/CA

- **CSMA/CA** = collision **avoidance**; used in **wireless (802.11 Wi-Fi)** because collisions **cannot** be reliably detected (hidden terminal); uses **IFS**, **contention window/backoff**, and optional **RTS/CTS**; ACKs confirm.

Controlled Access

- **Reservation**: stations reserve slots in advance.
- **Polling**: a **primary** station invites secondaries to send (**poll/select**).
- **Token passing**: a **token** circulates; only the holder may transmit (**Token Ring, FDDI**).

Channelization

- **FDMA**: each station a **frequency band**.
- **TDMA**: each station a **time slot**.
- **CDMA**: all use **same frequency/time**, separated by orthogonal **codes (chip sequences)**.

Protocol	Type	Efficiency/Use
Pure ALOHA	Random	18.4%
Slotted ALOHA	Random	36.8%
CSMA/CD	Random	Wired Ethernet
CSMA/CA	Random	Wi-Fi
Token passing	Controlled	Deterministic

Memory Trick

- Slotted ALOHA **doubles** pure ALOHA: **18.4% -> 36.8%** ($1/2e \rightarrow 1/e$).

CBT Trap

- **CD** = wired Ethernet; **CA** = Wi-Fi. Min Ethernet frame **64 bytes** comes from **2 x Tp** requirement. Pure ALOHA vulnerable period is **2T**; slotted is **T**.

Ethernet and LAN Devices

IEEE 802.3 Ethernet Frame Format

- Fields: **Preamble (7 B)**, **SFD (1 B)**, **Destination MAC (6 B)**, **Source MAC (6 B)**, **Type/Length (2 B)**, **Data (46-1500 B)**, **FCS/CRC (4 B)**.
- Preamble (7 bytes)** = alternating 1010... for sync; **SFD = 10101011**.
- FCS = CRC-32**.

Min/Max Frame Size

- Minimum frame = **64 bytes** (512 bits) to support **CSMA/CD** collision detection.
- Maximum frame = **1518 bytes** (payload **1500 = MTU**); minimum payload **46 bytes** (padded if less).

MAC Addressing

- MAC address = 48 bits (6 bytes)**, shown as **12 hex digits**; first **24 bits = OUI** (vendor).
- Unicast**: LSB of first byte = **0**; **Multicast**: LSB = **1**; **Broadcast = FF:FF:FF:FF:FF:FF** (all 1s).
- MAC is **flat, burned-in (physical)**; does not change across the journey within a LAN.

Fast / Gigabit Ethernet

- Ethernet = 10 Mbps**; **Fast Ethernet = 100 Mbps**; **Gigabit = 1 Gbps**; **10G = 10 Gbps**.

Devices and Layers

- Hub/Repeater: Physical (L1)**; regenerates signal; **one collision domain, one broadcast domain**; no filtering.
- Bridge/Switch: Data Link (L2)**; **MAC learning** via source addresses, forwards by MAC table; each port = **separate collision domain**; switch = multiport bridge.
- Router: Network (L3)**; forwards by **IP**; separates **broadcast domains**; runs routing protocols.
- Gateway**: operates up to **Application (L7)**; **protocol converter** between dissimilar networks.

Device	Layer	Collision domains	Broadcast domains
Hub	L1	1	1
Switch	L2	per port	1 (per VLAN)
Router	L3	per port	per port

Collision vs Broadcast Domain

- Collision domain**: set of devices that can **collide**; separated by **switch/router/bridge**, NOT by hub.
- Broadcast domain**: reached by a **broadcast** frame; separated only by **router** (or VLAN).

Spanning Tree Protocol

- STP (802.1D)**: prevents **Layer-2 loops** by blocking redundant links to form a **loop-free tree**; elects a **root bridge** (lowest **Bridge ID**); uses **BPDUs**.

VLAN and 802.11 WLAN

- VLAN**: logically segments a switch into multiple **broadcast domains**; tag = **802.1Q (4 bytes, 12-bit VLAN ID)**.

- **IEEE 802.11** = **Wi-Fi WLAN**; uses **CSMA/CA**; modes **infrastructure (AP)** and **ad-hoc**.

Memory Trick

- "**Hub=1/1, Switch=many/1, Router=many/many**" (collision/broadcast domains).

CBT Trap

- Only a **router** (or VLAN) breaks a **broadcast domain**; switches break **collision** domains. **Switch** learns **source** MAC, forwards by **destination** MAC. Min Ethernet frame = **64 B**.

Network Layer Services

Core Functions

- **Logical addressing (IP)**, **routing** (path selection), and **forwarding** (moving a packet from input to output port).
- Provides **host-to-host** delivery; the Internet's network layer is **connectionless/best-effort (IP)**.

Forwarding vs Routing

- **Routing** = building the **routing table** (control plane, global, slow).
- **Forwarding** = the **per-packet** lookup and switch to output (data plane, local, fast).

CBT Trap

- **Routing** = make the table; **forwarding** = use the table. Control plane vs data plane.

Datagram vs Virtual Circuit (Network Layer)

- **Datagram**: each packet independent, **full destination IP**, may reorder; **IP**.
- **VC**: setup, **label-based**, ordered; **ATM/MPLS/Frame Relay**.

IPv4 Addressing

Address Structure

- **IPv4** = **32 bits** = **4 octets**, written **dotted decimal** (each octet **0-255**); total **2^{32} ~ 4.3 billion** addresses.
- Split into **network ID** + **host ID**.

Classful Addressing

Class	Leading bits	First octet	Default mask	Hosts
A	0	1-126	/8 (255.0.0.0)	$2^{24}-2$
B	10	128-191	/16 (255.255.0.0)	$2^{16}-2$
C	110	192-223	/24 (255.255.255.0)	2^8-2
D	1110	224-239	multicast	-
E	1111	240-255	reserved	-

- **127.x.x.x** = **loopback** (not class A usable); **0.x** reserved.

Network/Host IDs and Special Addresses

- **Network address**: host bits all **0**.
- **Broadcast address**: host bits all **1** (**directed broadcast**); **255.255.255.255** = limited broadcast.
- **Loopback**: **127.0.0.1**.
- Usable hosts = **$2^h - 2$** (subtract network + broadcast).

Private IP Ranges

- **10.0.0.0/8** (Class A), **172.16.0.0/12** (Class B), **192.168.0.0/16** (Class C); not routable on public Internet (use **NAT**).

- **169.254.0.0/16** = **APIPA** (link-local, auto).

Classless Addressing (CIDR)

- **CIDR** = **Classless Inter-Domain Routing**; uses **/n** prefix instead of fixed classes; mask = n leading **1s**.
- Block size = **$2^{(32-n)}$** addresses; flexible allocation, reduces routing table size via **aggregation**.

Subnetting

- **Subnetting**: borrow **host** bits to create **subnets**; new mask longer.
- Number of subnets = **2^s** (s = borrowed bits); hosts per subnet = **$2^h - 2$** .
- **Block size (increment)** = **256 - mask octet value**; subnet boundaries are multiples of the block size.
- **Subnet address** = host bits 0; **broadcast** = host bits 1; **valid range** = in between.

VLSM

- **VLSM** = **Variable-Length Subnet Masking**: subnets of **different** sizes from one block; allocate **largest first**; reduces address waste.

Supernetting / Route Aggregation

- **Supernetting**: combine contiguous networks into one **shorter-prefix** route; opposite of subnetting; used in **CIDR** to **aggregate** routes.

Address Block Problems

- Given an IP and mask: **network** = **IP AND mask**; **broadcast** = **network OR (NOT mask)**; **first host** = **network+1**; **last host** = **broadcast-1**.

Memory Trick

- **Block size** = **256 - mask**. Hosts = **$2^h - 2$** . Subnets = **2^s** . **/30** gives **2** hosts (point-to-point).

CBT Trap

- Subtract **2** for usable hosts (network + broadcast). A **/31** (RFC 3021) allows **2** hosts with no broadcast (point-to-point). **/32** = single host. Classful default masks: A=**/8**, B=**/16**, C=**/24**.

IPv4 Datagram

Header Fields

- **IPv4 header** = **20 bytes** minimum, **60 bytes** max (with options); **Version (4 bits)**, **IHL**, **Type of Service/DSCP**, **Total Length (16 bits)**, **Identification**, **Flags (3 bits)**, **Fragment Offset (13 bits)**, **TTL (8 bits)**, **Protocol (8 bits)**, **Header Checksum**, **Source IP**, **Destination IP**, **Options**.
- **IHL** counts header length in **4-byte words** (min **5** = 20 B, max **15** = 60 B).
- **Total Length** = header + data, max **65535** bytes.

TTL, Protocol, Checksum, Total Length

- **TTL**: decremented by each **router**; at **0** packet dropped, ICMP **Time Exceeded** sent; prevents **loops**.
- **Protocol** field: **1 = ICMP**, **6 = TCP**, **17 = UDP**, **2 = IGMP**.
- **Header checksum**: covers **header only**; recomputed at **each hop** (because TTL changes).

Fragmentation and Reassembly

- **MTU** = max frame payload of a link (**Ethernet = 1500 B**); larger packets are **fragmented**.
- **Identification**: same for all fragments of a packet.
- **Flags**: **DF (Don't Fragment)**, **MF (More Fragments)** = 1 on all but last.
- **Fragment Offset**: position of fragment in original, in units of **8 bytes**.
- Each fragment's data (except last) must be a **multiple of 8 bytes**.
- Reassembly done only at **destination**.

Memory Trick

- Offset is in **8-byte** units. Protocol: **TCP=6**, **UDP=17**, **ICMP=1**. Header min/max = **20/60**.

CBT Trap

- **Fragment offset** counts **8-byte** units, so each non-last fragment payload is a multiple of **8**. **MF=0** on the **last** fragment. **TTL** change forces checksum **recompute** at every router. Reassembly only at the **destination**, never intermediate.

IPv6

128-bit Addressing

- **IPv6** = **128 bits** = **8 groups** of **4 hex digits**, colon-separated; **2¹²⁸** addresses.
- Shorthand: drop **leading zeros**; one run of zeros -> **::** (only once).

Header Simplification

- **IPv6 header** = fixed **40 bytes**; fewer fields; **no checksum**, **no fragmentation by routers** (only source), no header length field; uses **extension headers**.
- **TTL** renamed **Hop Limit**; **Protocol** -> **Next Header**; adds **Flow Label**.

Transition

- **Dual stack**: run **IPv4 and IPv6** together.
- **Tunneling**: encapsulate **IPv6 in IPv4**.
- **Translation (NAT64)**: convert between versions.

CBT Trap

- IPv6 has **no header checksum** and routers do **not fragment**. Header is **fixed 40 B** (vs IPv4 variable **20-60**). **::** can appear only **once**.

Routing Algorithms

Static vs Dynamic Routing; Metrics

- **Static routing**: manually configured; no overhead; fails on **topology change**; good for small/stub networks.
- **Dynamic routing**: routers **exchange** info, adapt automatically; uses **metrics** = **hop count, bandwidth, delay, cost, load, reliability**.

Shortest Path Routing (Dijkstra)

- **Dijkstra's algorithm**: computes **single-source shortest paths** on non-negative weights; greedy, picks nearest unvisited node.
- Complexity: **$O(V^2)$** with array, **$O((V+E) \log V)$** with binary heap; the basis of **Link State** routing.

Flooding

- **Flooding**: every incoming packet sent on **all** links except the one it arrived on; guarantees delivery but **duplicates**; controlled by **TTL/hop count** or **sequence numbers**.

Distance Vector Routing

- **Distance Vector (DV)**: each router shares its **whole table** (vector of distances) with **neighbors** only (**Bellman-Ford** basis); "**routing by rumor**".
- **Bellman-Ford**: $D_x(y) = \min \text{ over neighbors } v \text{ of } [c(x,v) + D_v(y)]$.
- **Count-to-infinity**: bad news propagates slowly; loops cause metrics to climb to **infinity (16 in RIP)**.
- **Split horizon**: don't advertise a route back on the interface you **learned** it; **poison reverse**: advertise it with **infinite** metric.
- **RIP**: DV protocol, metric = **hop count**, max **15 (16 = infinity/unreachable)**, updates every **30 s**, uses **UDP port 520**.

Link State Routing

- **Link State (LS)**: each router **floods** its link costs (**LSP**) to **all** routers, builds full **topology database**, runs **Dijkstra** locally.
- Converges fast, no count-to-infinity; more **memory/CPU**.
- **OSPF**: LS protocol, metric = **cost (bandwidth-based)**, uses **areas**, IP protocol number **89**, supports **VLSM**.

Hierarchical Routing, AS, BGP

- **Autonomous System (AS)**: a network under single administrative control, has an **AS number**.
- **IGP** (within AS): **RIP, OSPF**; **EGP** (between AS): **BGP**.
- **BGP**: **path-vector** protocol, the routing protocol of the **Internet**, uses **TCP port 179**.

Feature	Distance Vector	Link State
Shares	Whole table	Link states (LSP)
With	Neighbors	All routers
Algorithm	Bellman-Ford	Dijkstra
Convergence	Slow	Fast
Example	RIP	OSPF

Feature	Distance Vector	Link State
Problem	Count-to-infinity	High memory

Memory Trick

- DV = "**tell neighbors everything**"; LS = "**tell everyone your links**". RIP hop max = **15**, infinity = **16**.

CBT Trap

- RIP**=DV/hop count/port **520**; **OSPF**=LS/cost/proto **89**; **BGP**=path-vector/**TCP 179**. **Count-to-infinity** afflicts **DV**, not LS. Dijkstra needs **non-negative** weights.

IP Support Protocols

ARP (Address Resolution Protocol)

- ARP**: maps a known **IP** to a **MAC** address within a LAN; **broadcast** request ("**who has IP?**"), **unicast** reply.
- Results cached in **ARP cache** (timeout-based); operates between **L2 and L3**.
- Gratuitous ARP**: announce own mapping (detect duplicate IP).

RARP

- RARP**: maps **MAC -> IP** (reverse); obsolete, replaced by **BOOTP/DHCP**.

ICMP

- ICMP**: **error reporting** and diagnostics for IP; encapsulated in **IP** (protocol **1**); not for data.
- Messages: **Echo request/reply (ping)**, **Destination Unreachable**, **Time Exceeded (TTL=0)**, **Redirect**, **Source Quench**.
- ping**: tests reachability (echo); **traceroute/tracert**: increments **TTL** to discover each hop via **Time Exceeded**.

DHCP

- DHCP**: dynamically assigns **IP, mask, gateway, DNS**; client **UDP port 68**, server **UDP port 67**.
- DORA**: **Discover -> Offer -> Request -> Acknowledge**.
- Lease**: time-limited assignment; renewed at **T1 (50%)** and **T2 (87.5%)**.

NAT

- NAT**: translates **private** addresses to **public**; conserves IPv4.
- Static NAT**: 1-to-1 fixed; **Dynamic NAT**: from a pool; **PAT/overloading**: many-to-one using **port numbers** (most common, home routers).

Memory Trick

- DORA** = Discover, Offer, Request, Ack. DHCP ports = **67 server / 68 client**. ARP = **IP->MAC**; RARP = **MAC->IP**.

CBT Trap

- ARP** resolves **IP->MAC** (forward); **RARP** the reverse. **ICMP** reports errors but does NOT correct them and is **not** a transport protocol. DHCP server=**67**, client=**68** (often swapped). **traceroute** exploits **TTL** expiry.

Transport Layer Services

Process-to-Process Delivery; Ports and Sockets

- Transport layer gives **process-to-process** (end-to-end) delivery; network layer only does **host-to-host**.
- **Port number** = **16 bits (0-65535)** identifies a process; **socket** = **IP + port**.
- A connection is identified by the **4-tuple**: **source IP, source port, dest IP, dest port**.

Multiplexing and Demultiplexing

- **Multiplexing**: gather data from many sockets, add headers, pass down.
- **Demultiplexing**: deliver incoming segments to the correct **socket** using port numbers (and 4-tuple for TCP).

Connection-oriented vs Connectionless

- **TCP** = connection-oriented, reliable, ordered; **UDP** = connectionless, unreliable, fast.

UDP

UDP Header

- **UDP header** = fixed **8 bytes**: **Source Port (2)**, **Destination Port (2)**, **Length (2)**, **Checksum (2)**.
- **Length** = header + data; minimum **8**.

UDP Checksum

- **Optional** in IPv4 (0 = unused), **mandatory** in IPv6; computed over **pseudo-header + UDP header + data**.

Use Cases

- **DNS, DHCP, TFTP, streaming, VoIP, online gaming, SNMP** - where **speed** beats reliability.

CBT Trap

- UDP header is always **8 bytes** (4 fields). UDP has **no** sequencing, flow, or congestion control. Checksum is **optional** in IPv4 only.

TCP

TCP Header Fields

- **TCP header** = **20 bytes** min, **60** max; **Source/Dest Port (2 each)**, **Sequence Number (4)**, **Acknowledgment Number (4)**, **Data Offset/HLEN (4 bits)**, **Flags**, **Window Size (2)**, **Checksum (2)**, **Urgent Pointer (2)**, **Options**.
- Flags: **URG, ACK, PSH, RST, SYN, FIN** (and ECE/CWR).

Sequence and Acknowledgment Numbers

- TCP is **byte-oriented**: sequence number = byte number of **first byte** in segment.

- ACK number = **next expected byte** (**cumulative**).
- Initial sequence number (**ISN**) is **random**.

Connection Management

- **Three-way handshake**: **SYN -> SYN+ACK -> ACK**; exchanges **ISNs** and options (**MSS**, **window scale**).
- **Connection termination**: **four-way** (**FIN -> ACK -> FIN -> ACK**); each direction closed independently (**half-close**).
- **TCP states**: **LISTEN**, **SYN-SENT**, **SYN-RECEIVED**, **ESTABLISHED**, **FIN-WAIT**, **TIME-WAIT** (**2*MSL**), **CLOSED**.

Flow Control

- TCP uses a **sliding window**; receiver advertises **rwnd** (**advertised window**); sender limited by **min(rwnd, cwnd)**.
- Prevents **receiver** buffer overflow; **zero window** pauses sender; **persist timer** probes.

Error Control

- **Retransmission** on timeout (**RTO**) or **3 duplicate ACKs**; **cumulative ACK**; checksum detects corruption.
- **RTO** computed from **RTT** via **Jacobson/Karn** (**EstimatedRTT**, **DevRTT**).

Congestion Control

- Goal: avoid overwhelming the **network** (vs flow control = receiver).
- **Congestion window (cwnd)**: sender's estimate of safe in-flight data.
- **Slow start**: cwnd starts at **1 MSS**, **doubles** each RTT (**exponential**) until **ssthresh**.
- **Congestion avoidance (AIMD)**: above ssthresh, cwnd grows **linearly** (+1 MSS/RTT) - **additive increase**; on loss, **multiplicative decrease**.
- **Timeout**: ssthresh = **cwnd/2**, cwnd = **1** (back to slow start).
- **Fast retransmit**: **3 duplicate ACKs** -> retransmit immediately without waiting for timeout.
- **Fast recovery**: after 3 dup ACKs, ssthresh = cwnd/2, cwnd = ssthresh (skip slow start) - **TCP Reno**.

cwnd Evolution Computation

- Slow start: **1, 2, 4, 8, 16...** (double per RTT) until **ssthresh**.
- After ssthresh: **+1 per RTT** linear.
- On **timeout**: ssthresh = half of current cwnd, cwnd = **1**.
- On **3 dup ACK**: ssthresh = half, cwnd = ssthresh (Reno).

TCP vs UDP

Feature	TCP	UDP
Connection	Connection-oriented	Connectionless
Reliability	Reliable	Unreliable
Ordering	Yes	No
Header	20-60 B	8 B
Speed	Slower	Faster
Flow/Congestion	Yes	No
Use	HTTP, FTP, SMTP	DNS, VoIP, streaming

Memory Trick

- Slow start = **exponential**; congestion avoidance = **linear (AIMD)**. **Timeout** -> cwnd=1; **3 dup ACK** -> fast recovery. Handshake = **3-way**, teardown = **4-way**.

CBT Trap

- **Flow control** protects **receiver**; **congestion control** protects **network**. Slow start is **exponential** (misleading name). On **timeout** cwnd resets to **1**; on **3 dup ACKs** (Reno) it halves. TCP header **20-60 B**, UDP fixed **8 B**. TIME-WAIT = **2*MSL**.

Sockets

Socket = IP + Port

- A **socket** uniquely identifies a network endpoint as **IP address + port number**.

Port Ranges

- **Well-known ports: 0-1023** (assigned by IANA: HTTP 80, etc.).
- **Registered ports: 1024-49151**.
- **Dynamic/ephemeral/private ports: 49152-65535** (client side).

CBT Trap

- Well-known **0-1023**; registered **1024-49151**; ephemeral **49152-65535**. Port field is **16 bits** (max **65535**).

DNS (Domain Name System)

Namespace Hierarchy

- **DNS** maps **domain names** to **IP addresses**; a **distributed, hierarchical** database.
- Hierarchy: **root (.)** -> **TLD (.com, .org, .in)** -> **authoritative (example.com)** servers.
- **13** logical **root server** clusters worldwide.

Record Types

Record	Maps
A	name -> IPv4
AAAA	name -> IPv6
MX	mail exchange server
CNAME	alias -> canonical name
NS	name server
PTR	IP -> name (reverse)

Iterative vs Recursive Resolution

- **Recursive**: resolver does all the work and returns the **final** answer to the client.
- **Iterative**: each server returns a **referral** to the next server; the client/resolver chases it.

DNS Caching, TTL, Port

- Answers cached for the record's **TTL**; reduces load and latency.
- DNS uses **UDP port 53** for queries, **TCP port 53** for **zone transfers** and large responses.

Memory Trick

- **A=IPv4, AAAA=IPv6, MX=mail, CNAME=alias, NS=nameserver, PTR=reverse**. DNS port = **53**.

CBT Trap

- DNS uses **UDP 53** normally but **TCP 53** for zone transfers / responses > 512 B. **CNAME** is an alias, **PTR** is reverse lookup. Recursive vs iterative is who does the **chasing**.

Email Protocols

Email Architecture

- **MUA (Mail User Agent)**: client (Outlook); **MTA (Mail Transfer Agent)**: server relay (SMTP); **MDA (Mail Delivery Agent)**: delivers to mailbox.

SMTP

- **SMTP**: **push** protocol, sends mail between servers and from client to server; **TCP port 25** (or **587** submission, **465** SMTPS).

POP3

- **POP3**: **pull**; downloads and usually **deletes** mail from server; **TCP port 110** (POP3S **995**); no sync across devices.

IMAP

- **IMAP**: **pull**; keeps mail on server, supports **folders/sync** across devices; **TCP port 143** (IMAPS **993**).

MIME

- **MIME**: extends email to carry **non-ASCII** data (**images, attachments**); adds headers like **Content-Type**.

Protocol	Port	Role
SMTP	25	Push/send
POP3	110	Pull/download
IMAP	143	Pull/sync

CBT Trap

- **SMTP=push (25)**, **POP3=110**, **IMAP=143**. POP3 **deletes** from server; IMAP **syncs**. MIME enables **attachments**, it is not a transfer protocol.

Web (HTTP/HTTPS)

Request/Response Model

- **HTTP**: client-server, **request/response**, runs over **TCP port 80** (**HTTPS port 443**); **stateless**.

Methods

- **GET** (retrieve), **POST** (submit), **PUT** (replace/create), **DELETE**, **HEAD** (headers only), **PATCH**, **OPTIONS**.
- **GET** is **idempotent/safe**; **POST** is **not** idempotent.

Status Codes

Class	Meaning	Example
1xx	Informational	100 Continue
2xx	Success	200 OK
3xx	Redirection	301/304
4xx	Client error	404, 403, 400
5xx	Server error	500, 502, 503

Persistent vs Non-persistent

- **Non-persistent (HTTP/1.0)**: one **TCP connection per object**; **2 RTT** + transmit per object.
- **Persistent (HTTP/1.1)**: reuse one connection (**keep-alive**), supports **pipelining**; default.

Stateless; Cookies/Sessions

- HTTP is **stateless**; state added by **cookies** (client-side token) and **sessions** (server-side).

HTTPS/TLS

- **HTTPS** = HTTP over **TLS/SSL**; encrypts traffic; **port 443**; provides **confidentiality, integrity, authentication**.

Memory Trick

- HTTP=**80**, HTTPS=**443**. **2xx OK**, **3xx redirect**, **4xx you erred**, **5xx server erred**. **404**=not found, **500**=server error.

CBT Trap

- **GET** idempotent, **POST** not. **301**=permanent redirect, **302**=temporary, **304**=not modified. HTTP **1.1** is persistent by default. HTTP is **stateless** -> cookies add state.

File Transfer (FTP)

Control vs Data Connection

- **FTP** uses **two** TCP connections: **control = port 21** (commands), **data = port 20** (file transfer); control is **persistent**, data is **per-transfer**.

Active vs Passive Mode

- **Active**: server initiates the **data** connection back to client (from port **20**); problematic with client **firewalls/NAT**.
- **Passive**: client initiates **both** connections; firewall-friendly.

ASCII vs Binary Transfer

- **ASCII mode**: text, converts line endings; **Binary/image mode**: raw bytes for non-text files.

CBT Trap

- FTP control = **21**, data = **20**. **Active** = server connects back; **Passive** = client connects (NAT-friendly). FTP keeps **control** open through the session (**out-of-band** control).

Other Services

Telnet / SSH

- **Telnet**: remote login, **plaintext**, **TCP port 23** - insecure.
- **SSH**: secure encrypted remote login/tunneling, **TCP port 22** - replaces Telnet.

SNMP

- **SNMP**: **Simple Network Management Protocol**; manager/agent, **MIB**, uses **UDP ports 161 (agent) / 162 (trap)**.

Proxy / Web Caching

- **Proxy/cache**: intermediary that **caches** responses, reduces latency/bandwidth, can filter; **forward proxy** (client side) vs **reverse proxy** (server side).

CBT Trap

- **Telnet 23** (insecure) vs **SSH 22** (secure). **SNMP = UDP 161/162**. Proxy cache reduces **bandwidth** and **latency**.

Network Security: Foundations

Security Goals (CIA + AN)

- **Confidentiality**: only authorized parties can **read** data (**encryption**).
- **Integrity**: data not **altered** undetected (**hashing/MAC**).
- **Availability**: services remain **accessible** (anti-DoS).
- **Authentication**: verify **identity** of a party.
- **Non-repudiation**: sender **cannot deny** having sent (digital signatures).
- **Authorization/Access control**: what an authenticated party may **do**.

Memory Trick

- **CIA** = **Confidentiality, Integrity, Availability**. Add **Authentication** + **Non-repudiation** for the full set.

CBT Trap

- **Encryption** provides **confidentiality**, NOT integrity by itself. **Hashing** provides **integrity**, not confidentiality. **Digital signature** provides **authentication + integrity + non-repudiation**.

Active vs Passive Attacks

- **Passive**: eavesdropping, **traffic analysis** - hard to detect, easy to prevent (encryption).
- **Active**: **modification, masquerade/spoofing, replay, DoS** - easy to detect, hard to prevent.

Cryptography

Symmetric-Key Cryptography

- **Symmetric (secret-key)**: **same key** for encryption and decryption; **fast**; problem = **key distribution**.
- For **n** users, symmetric needs **$n(n-1)/2$** keys.
- Types: **block ciphers** (DES, AES) and **stream ciphers** (RC4).
- Modes: **ECB** (insecure, patterns leak), **CBC** (chaining + IV), **CTR**, **CFB/OFB**.

DES (Data Encryption Standard)

- **DES**: block size **64 bits**, key **56 bits** (64 with **8 parity** bits), **16 Feistel rounds**.
- Now **insecure** (key too short, brute-forceable).
- **3DES (Triple DES)**: applies DES **3 times**, effective key **112/168 bits**.

AES (Advanced Encryption Standard)

- **AES**: block size **128 bits**; key sizes **128/192/256 bits**; rounds **10/12/14** respectively.
- Based on **substitution-permutation network** (not Feistel); operations: **SubBytes, ShiftRows, MixColumns, AddRoundKey**.
- Successor to DES (**Rijndael**); current standard.

Cipher	Block	Key	Rounds	Structure
DES	64	56	16	Feistel
3DES	64	112/168	48	Feistel x3

Cipher	Block	Key	Rounds	Structure
AES	128	128/192/256	10/12/14	SPN

Asymmetric-Key (Public-Key) Cryptography

- **Asymmetric: key pair** - **public key** (shared) and **private key** (secret); **slow**; solves **key distribution**.
- For **n** users needs only **2n** keys.
- **Confidentiality**: encrypt with **receiver's public** key, decrypt with **receiver's private**.
- **Authentication/signature**: encrypt (sign) with **sender's private** key, verify with **sender's public**.
- Examples: **RSA**, **Diffie-Hellman**, **ECC**, **ElGamal**.

RSA Algorithm

- **RSA**: based on difficulty of **factoring large primes**.
- Steps: pick primes **p, q**; **n = p x q**; **phi(n) = (p-1)(q-1)**; choose **e** with **gcd(e, phi)=1**; compute **d = e⁻¹ mod phi(n)**.
- Public key = **(e, n)**; private key = **(d, n)**.
- Encrypt: **C = M^e mod n**; Decrypt: **M = C^d mod n**.

Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange

- **Diffie-Hellman**: securely establishes a **shared secret** over an insecure channel; based on **discrete logarithm** problem.
- Vulnerable to **man-in-the-middle** without authentication.

Feature	Symmetric	Asymmetric
Keys	Same (1)	Pair (public/private)
Speed	Fast	Slow
Keys for n users	$n(n-1)/2$	2n
Key distribution	Hard	Easy
Examples	DES, AES, RC4	RSA, DH, ECC

Memory Trick

- **Confidentiality** -> encrypt with **receiver public**. **Signature** -> sign with **sender private**. Symmetric keys = $n(n-1)/2$; asymmetric = **2n**.

CBT Trap

- For **confidentiality**: use **receiver's public** key. For **authentication**: use **sender's private** key. RSA security = **factoring**; DH = **discrete log**. AES block always **128 bits** even with 256-bit key. DES key = **56** effective bits.

Hashing and Integrity

Cryptographic Hash Functions

- **Hash function**: maps arbitrary input to **fixed-size** digest; **one-way** (irreversible) and **collision-resistant**.
- Properties: **pre-image resistance**, **second pre-image resistance**, **collision resistance**, **avalanche effect**.
- **MD5**: **128-bit** digest - **broken** (collisions).
- **SHA-1**: **160-bit** - **deprecated**.
- **SHA-256** (SHA-2 family): **256-bit** - current.

MAC and HMAC

- **MAC (Message Authentication Code)**: hash with a **shared secret key** -> provides **integrity + authentication** (not non-repudiation).
- **HMAC**: keyed-hash MAC construction.

CBT Trap

- **Hash** alone gives **integrity** only; **MAC** adds **authentication** but **not** non-repudiation (shared key). **MD5=128 bit**, **SHA-1=160**, **SHA-256=256**. Hash is **one-way**, not encryption.

Digital Signatures and Certificates

Digital Signatures

- **Digital signature**: sender **hashes** the message, then **encrypts the hash with their private key**; receiver decrypts with sender's **public key** and compares hashes.
- Provides **authentication, integrity, non-repudiation**; does NOT provide **confidentiality** (unless combined with encryption).
- Algorithms: **RSA, DSA, ECDSA**.

Digital Certificates and PKI

- **Certificate**: binds a **public key** to an **identity**, signed by a **CA (Certificate Authority)**; standard **X.509**.
- **PKI**: hierarchy of **CAs, registration authorities, CRL** (revocation), trust anchors (**root CA**).

Memory Trick

- Sign = "**hash then encrypt with private key**". Verify = "**decrypt with public key, compare hash**". Certificate = **public key + identity** signed by **CA**.

CBT Trap

- Digital signature uses **sender's private key** on the **hash**, not the whole message (for speed). It does **not** give confidentiality. **X.509** = certificate standard. **CA** vouches for the public key.

SSL/TLS

SSL/TLS Overview

- **SSL/TLS**: secures application traffic (**HTTPS**); sits between **Application** and **Transport**; **TLS** succeeds **SSL**.
- Provides **confidentiality (symmetric)**, **authentication (certificates/asymmetric)**, **integrity (MAC)**.
- **TLS handshake**: negotiate cipher, authenticate server (certificate), exchange keys (**asymmetric**) to derive a **symmetric session key**, then bulk encrypt with **symmetric**.
- Sub-protocols: **Handshake, Record, Alert, Change Cipher Spec**.

CBT Trap

- TLS uses **asymmetric** only for the **handshake/key exchange**, then **symmetric** for bulk data (speed). HTTPS = **port 443**. TLS provides all of **C, I, A**.

Firewalls and IDS

Firewalls

- **Firewall**: filters traffic between networks by **rules/policy**; placed at the **perimeter**.
- **Packet-filtering** firewall: checks **IP/port/protocol** headers (stateless, L3/L4).
- **Stateful inspection**: tracks **connection state**.
- **Application/proxy** firewall: inspects **application-layer** content (L7).
- **DMZ**: a buffer subnet for public-facing servers.

IDS / IPS

- **IDS (Intrusion Detection System)**: **detects** and alerts (passive).
- **IPS (Intrusion Prevention System)**: detects and **blocks** (active, inline).
- Detection methods: **signature-based** (known patterns) and **anomaly-based** (deviation from baseline).

Type	Layer	Inspects
Packet filter	L3/L4	Headers
Stateful	L3/L4	Connection state
Proxy/App	L7	Content

CBT Trap

- **IDS** = detect/alert (passive); **IPS** = block (inline). **Signature-based** catches **known** attacks; **anomaly-based** catches **unknown/zero-day** but more **false positives**. Packet filter = **stateless L3/L4**.

Common Attacks

Attack Catalog

- **DoS/DDoS**: flood to exhaust resources (**availability**).
- **Man-in-the-Middle (MITM)**: intercept/alter between parties.
- **Replay**: resend captured valid messages (countered by **nonce/timestamp**).
- **Spoofing**: forge **IP/MAC/email** identity.
- **ARP poisoning**: fake ARP replies to redirect LAN traffic.
- **DNS spoofing/cache poisoning**: inject false DNS records.
- **Phishing**: trick users into revealing credentials.
- **SQL injection**: inject SQL via input.
- **XSS**: inject scripts into web pages.
- **Brute force / dictionary**: guess keys/passwords.
- **Smurf**: ICMP broadcast amplification; **SYN flood**: half-open TCP connections.

Attack	Targets	Countermeasure
DDoS	Availability	Rate limit, filtering
MITM	Confidentiality	TLS , auth
Replay	Integrity	Nonce/timestamp
ARP poison	LAN	Static ARP, DAI
SYN flood	TCP	SYN cookies

Memory Trick

- **Replay** -> defend with **nonce/timestamp**. **SYN flood** -> **SYN cookies**. **MITM** -> **TLS + certificates**.

CBT Trap

- **DoS** attacks **availability**; **MITM** attacks **confidentiality/integrity**. **SYN flood** exploits the **3-way handshake** (half-open). **ARP poisoning** works only on the **local LAN**. **Replay** defeated by **nonce**.

CIL MT Exam Focus / Practice Checklist

Port Numbers and Protocol-to-Layer Mapping

Port	Protocol	Transport	Layer
20/21	FTP (data/control)	TCP	App
22	SSH	TCP	App
23	Telnet	TCP	App
25	SMTP	TCP	App
53	DNS	UDP/TCP	App
67/68	DHCP (server/client)	UDP	App
69	TFTP	UDP	App
80	HTTP	TCP	App
110	POP3	TCP	App
143	IMAP	TCP	App
161/162	SNMP	UDP	App
179	BGP	TCP	App
443	HTTPS	TCP	App
520	RIP	UDP	App

- Protocol numbers (IP header): **ICMP=1**, **IGMP=2**, **TCP=6**, **UDP=17**, **OSPF=89**.

Formula Quick Sheet

- Transmission delay** = L/B ; **Propagation delay** = d/v ; $a = T_p/T_t$.
- Stop-and-Wait efficiency** = $1/(1+2a)$.
- Sliding window efficiency** = $N/(1+2a)$; optimal $N = 1+2a$.
- BDP** = Bandwidth x RTT.
- Nyquist**: $C = 2B \log_2 L$; **Shannon**: $C = B \log_2(1+S/N)$.
- Bit rate** = baud x $\log_2 L$.
- Hosts per subnet** = $2^h - 2$; **subnets** = 2^s ; **block size** = 256 - mask octet.
- GBN window** = $2^m - 1$; **SR window** = $2^{(m-1)}$.
- Mesh links** = $n(n-1)/2$.
- Pure ALOHA** = 18.4%; **Slotted ALOHA** = 36.8%.
- Symmetric keys** = $n(n-1)/2$; **Asymmetric keys** = $2n$.

Subnetting / CIDR Computations

- Steps: identify **mask** -> **block size** = 256 - **mask** -> find subnet the IP falls in -> **network/broadcast/range**.
- /30** = 4 addresses, 2 usable (point-to-point links).
- /24** = 256 addresses, 254 hosts.

Fragmentation Offset/Size Computations

- Offset** in 8-byte units; each non-last fragment data multiple of 8.
- Number of fragments for data D and per-fragment payload P = **ceil(D/P)**.

Sliding Window Efficiency

- Compute $a = T_p/T_t$, then $N/(1+2a)$; need at least m bits where $2^m \geq N+1$ (GBN).

TCP Congestion Window Evolution

- Track **cwnd** per RTT: **slow start doubles** until ssthresh, then **+1 linear**; reset on loss.

CRC and Hamming Computation

- CRC: append r zeros, **XOR divide**, remainder = FCS.
- Hamming: $2^r \geq m+r+1$, parity at **powers of 2**, syndrome locates error.

Delay / Throughput / BDP

- Total delay = sum of **transmission + propagation + queuing + processing** over all hops.
- **Throughput = efficiency x bandwidth.**

Header Field Identification

- **IPv4 = 20-60 B, TCP = 20-60 B, UDP = 8 B, IPv6 = 40 B fixed, Ethernet header = 14 B + 4 B FCS.**

Memory Trick

- "**20-20-8-40**" = IPv4, TCP, UDP, IPv6 header sizes. Ports: "**21 22 23 25 53 80 110 143 443**".

CBT Trap

- **DNS** and **DHCP** use **UDP** (DNS also TCP for zone transfers). **IPv6** header **fixed 40 B** with **no checksum**. Usable hosts subtract **2**. Offset in **8-byte** units. **Slow start** is exponential.